

MORPHOLOGY & SPELLING

Middle School | Unit 4

Suffix -al



Today I am learning that the suffix **-al** often forms an adjective meaning *relating to or connected with* something.

1 Learn the Meaning

The suffix **-al** commonly forms **adjectives**. These words often mean **relating to, connected with, or having the quality of** the base word.

personal

relating to a person

seasonal

relating to a season

cultural

relating to culture

natural

relating to nature

2 Build the Word

Add **-al** to the base word. Notice when a final **e** is dropped before the suffix is added.

Base word	Suffix	New word	What it describes
person	-al		
season	-al		
culture	-al		
nature	-al		
region	-al		

3 Read and Notice

Read the passage below.

For a geography project, the class explored how a region can be described through its **natural**, **cultural** and **seasonal** features. They studied the **natural** landscape, then compared **regional** foods, music and celebrations. Mira investigated a **coastal** town where tourism changes with the seasons. **Seasonal** businesses become busy in summer, local markets feature **regional** produce, and a **musical** festival attracts visitors each year. Her report also included a **personal** reflection about visiting the area with her family. When Mira edited her work, she noticed that many describing words ended in **-al**. Some were built by adding the suffix directly, as in person + al = personal and season + al = seasonal. Others changed slightly: nature + al becomes natural and culture + al becomes cultural.



Highlight the **-al** words. Underline the **base word** or related form when you can identify one.

4 Word Detective

Choose one **-al** word from the passage and investigate its structure and meaning.

- Write an **-al** word from the passage.

- What **base or related word** can you identify?

- What does the adjective mean in this context?

- Write a word sum or explain any spelling change.

5 Sort the Words

Sort the words by whether the base spelling stays the same.

personal seasonal regional musical natural

cultural central global

Base stays the same

Base spelling changes

6 Use It in Writing

Complete the sentence starters.

- A cultural tradition can _____

- Use an **-al** adjective in your own sentence.



Parent check

Tick the skills your learner has demonstrated.

- ☐ Recognises the suffix **-al**
- ☐ Finds a base or related word
- ☐ Explains the adjective meaning
- ☐ Spells and uses derived words



Capture idea:

Find an **-al** word in a book, article or information text. Record its base or related word and explain what the adjective is connected with.